

LDS+N for Excel

A quick tour of the add-in

LDS+N is an Excel add-in for people who spend their day inside wide tables of data that arrive from somewhere else — an export, a report, a download. It does not try to make a worksheet perfect. It tries to get you from "raw dump" to "mostly presentable and easy to work with" in a few clicks, so that the remaining touch-ups are minutes of manual work rather than an hour.

Everything it does uses ordinary Excel features — tables, number formats, conditional formatting, a worksheet function. Once a workbook has been tidied with LDS+N, it stays tidied when it is opened on a machine that does not have the add-in.

This document walks through the features in the order you would typically use them on a fresh export: **Make Table** → **Format Columns** → **Group Columns** → **Row Viewer** → **Formula Report**. First, though, a look at the ribbon and one small feature you will use with all of the others.

The LDS+N ribbon tab

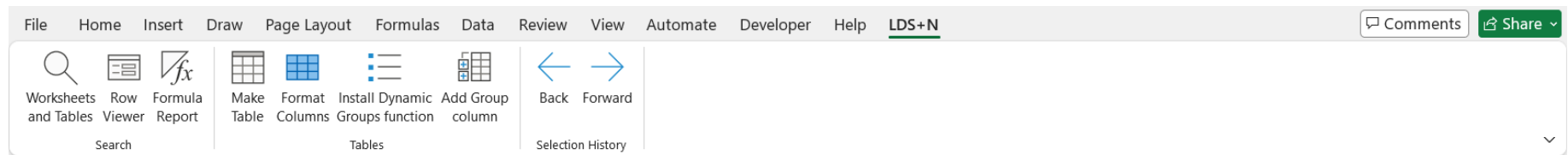


Figure 1 — The LDS+N ribbon tab. Left to right: Search group, Tables group, Selection History group.

The tab has three groups:

- **Search** — Worksheets and Tables (find and jump to a sheet or table by name), Row Viewer, and Formula Report.
- **Tables** — Make Table, Format Columns, and the two Dynamic Groups buttons.
- **Selection History** — Back and Forward, described next.

Getting around: Back and Forward

Excel has no "go back to where I was" command. LDS+N adds one. Every time you select a cell somewhere else — on the same sheet, on another sheet, or in another workbook — the previous location is remembered. **Alt+Left** (or the ribbon **Back** button) takes you back to where you came from; **Alt+Right** (or **Forward**) retraces your steps.

This behaves like the back and forward buttons in a web browser. It is most useful when you are bouncing between a summary and the detail behind it, or between a table and a lookup sheet, and it is what makes the Formula Report at the end of this document practical to use — you can jump from a report row to the cell it describes and come straight back.

1. Make Table

Data usually arrives as a plain range: gridlines on, nothing frozen, no filters, everything in the default style. This is what the sample data looks like when it is opened for the first time. Note that the two date columns are not even consistent — one has been formatted as a date and the other still shows Excel's internal serial numbers.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Region	State	City	Account	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Days to Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product	SKU
2	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41000	7/29/2026	46238	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
3	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41004	6/1/2026			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glasses, Clear (12)	SF-0012
4	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41008	1/7/2026	46030		1 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510
5	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41011	2/24/2026			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003
6	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41013	8/23/2026	46262		5 M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003
7	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41019	1/23/2026	46049		4 M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804
8	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41023	4/28/2026	46149		9 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
9	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41026	5/11/2026	46162		9 M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500
10	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41027	8/1/2026			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
11	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41032	1/2/2026	46030		6 M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
12	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41033	6/29/2026			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
13	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41035	8/20/2026	46259		5 A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804
14	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41038	1/15/2026			M. Okafor	Online	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500
15	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41041	8/3/2026	46239		2 M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	Romex 12/2 NM-B 250 ft	EL-1225
16	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41047	4/6/2026	46120		2 M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
17	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41050	6/5/2026	46183		5 M. Okafor	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
18	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41054	4/19/2026	46140		9 A. Reyes	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
19	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41057	6/25/2026	46200		2 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510
20	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41062	2/9/2026	46070		8 A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200
21	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41063	6/16/2026			A. Reyes	Direct	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
22	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41064	8/25/2026	46262		3 M. Okafor	Direct	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200
23	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41069	7/27/2026	46233		3 M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Cordless Drill 20V Kit	PT-2001
24	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41073	4/16/2026	46132		4 A. Reyes	Direct	Fasteners	Hex Bolt 1/2 x 2, Zinc (100)	FAS-1020
25	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41078	5/18/2026			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
26	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41085	7/17/2026			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
27	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41088	3/18/2026			A. Reyes	Direct	Power Tools	Circular Saw 7-1/4 in	PT-7250
28	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41093	3/19/2026			A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
29	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41098	1/10/2026	46036		4 M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000

Figure 2 — A typical starting point: a plain range with gridlines, unformatted dates, and no frozen header row.

With any cell in the data selected, click **Make Table**. In one step it:

- converts the range to an Excel table, which gives you filter buttons and structured column names;
- applies a plain, uncluttered table style;
- freezes the header row so it stays visible as you scroll;
- turns off gridlines.

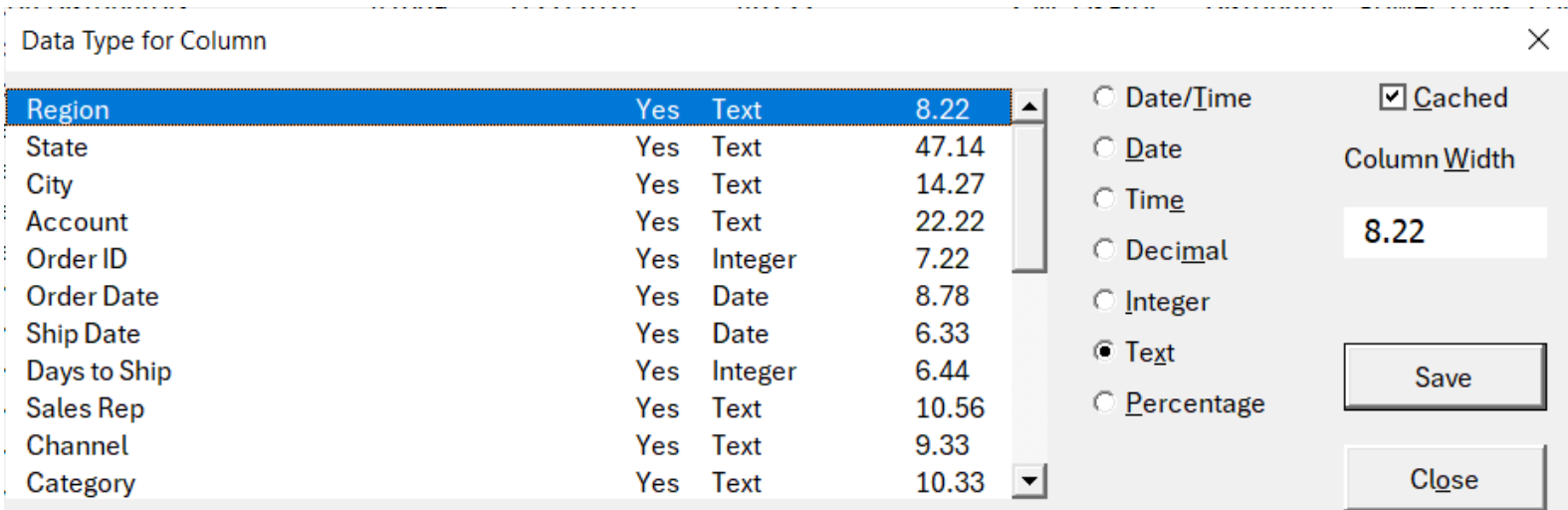
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Region	State	City	Account	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Days to Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product	SKU
2	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41000	7/29/2026	46238		6 M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
3	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41004	6/1/2026			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glasses, Clear (12)	SF-0012
4	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41008	1/7/2026	46030		1 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510
5	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41011	2/24/2026			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-100
6	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41013	8/23/2026	46262		5 M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-100
7	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41019	1/23/2026	46049		4 M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-380
8	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41023	4/28/2026	46149		9 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
9	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41026	5/11/2026	46162		9 M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500
10	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41027	8/1/2026			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
11	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41032	1/2/2026	46030		6 M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
12	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41033	6/29/2026			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
13	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41035	8/20/2026	46259		5 A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-380
14	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41038	1/15/2026			M. Okafor	Online	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500
15	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41041	8/3/2026	46239		2 M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	Romex 12/2 NM-B 250 ft	EL-1225
16	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41047	4/6/2026	46120		2 M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
17	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41050	6/5/2026	46183		5 M. Okafor	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
18	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41054	4/19/2026	46140		9 A. Reyes	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
19	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41057	6/25/2026	46200		2 A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510
20	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41062	2/9/2026	46070		8 A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200
21	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41063	6/16/2026			A. Reyes	Direct	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
22	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41064	8/25/2026	46262		3 M. Okafor	Direct	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200
23	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41069	7/27/2026	46233		3 M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Cordless Drill 20V Kit	PT-2000
24	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41073	4/16/2026	46132		4 A. Reyes	Direct	Fasteners	Hex Bolt 1/2 x 2, Zinc (100)	FAS-102
25	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41078	5/18/2026			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900
26	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41085	7/17/2026			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400
27	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41088	3/18/2026			A. Reyes	Direct	Power Tools	Circular Saw 7-1/4 in	PT-7250
28	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41093	3/19/2026			A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000
29	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41098	1/10/2026	46036		4 M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000

Figure 3 — After Make Table: the range is now a table with filters and a frozen header row.

You can, of course, do each of these things yourself. The point is that you no longer have to remember to.

2. Format Columns

This is the workhorse. Select a cell in the table and click **Format Columns** (or press **Ctrl+Shift+M**). LDS+N looks at the contents of every column and guesses its data type — text, integer, decimal, date, date/time, time, or percentage — and presents its guesses for review:



Column	Yes	Guessed Type	Value
Region	Yes	Text	8.22
State	Yes	Text	47.14
City	Yes	Text	14.27
Account	Yes	Text	22.22
Order ID	Yes	Integer	7.22
Order Date	Yes	Date	8.78
Ship Date	Yes	Date	6.33
Days to Ship	Yes	Integer	6.44
Sales Rep	Yes	Text	10.56
Channel	Yes	Text	9.33
Category	Yes	Text	10.33

On the right, the following options are available:

- ☐ Date/Time
- ☐ Date
- ☐ Time
- ☐ Decimal
- ☐ Integer
- ☒ Text
- ☐ Percentage

Additional settings: ☒ **Cached**, **Column Width** set to **8.22**. Buttons: **Save**, **Close**.

Figure 4 — The Data Type dialog. Each column is listed with its guessed type; select a row to override the type or the width.

You can accept the guesses as they are, or click a column and choose a different type on the right. Your choices are **cached by column name**, so the next time a report with the same column headings arrives, the dialog already knows what you decided last time. Over time the review step becomes a glance-and-close.

When you click **Close**, LDS+N applies to every column:

- a number format matching the data type — thousands separators for integers, two decimals for amounts, **yyyy-mm-dd** for dates (which sort correctly as text and are unambiguous across regions), a percent sign for percentages;
- wrapped, right-aligned headings for numeric columns, so a wide heading no longer forces a narrow column to be wide;
- a column width sized to the wider of the wrapped heading and the first row of data.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	
	Days to															
1	Region	State	City	Account	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product	SKU	Qty	Unit Price	Ext
2	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,000	2026-07-29	2026-08-04	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	50.00	14.25	7
3	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,004	2026-06-01			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glasses, Clear (12)	SF-0012	50.00	27.60	1,3
4	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,008	2026-01-07	2026-01-08	1	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510	10.00	13.40	1
5	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,011	2026-02-24			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	50.00	31.90	1,5
6	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,013	2026-08-23	2026-08-28	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	10.00	31.90	3
7	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,019	2026-01-23	2026-01-27	4	M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	6.00	22.75	1
8	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,023	2026-04-28	2026-05-07	9	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	15.00	42.00	6
9	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,026	2026-05-11	2026-05-20	9	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500	8.00	64.50	5
10	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,027	2026-08-01			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	2.00	19.50	
11	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,032	2026-01-02	2026-01-08	6	M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	10.00	19.50	1
12	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,033	2026-06-29			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	4.00	14.25	
13	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,035	2026-08-20	2026-08-25	5	A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	20.00	22.75	4
14	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,038	2026-01-15			M. Okafor	Online	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500	40.00	64.50	2,5
15	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,041	2026-08-03	2026-08-05	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	Romex 12/2 NM-B 250 ft	EL-1225	5.00	#####	5
16	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,047	2026-04-06	2026-04-08	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	24.00	42.00	1,0
17	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,050	2026-06-05	2026-06-10	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	30.00	42.00	1,2
18	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,054	2026-04-19	2026-04-28	9	A. Reyes	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	8.00	42.00	3
19	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,057	2026-06-25	2026-06-27	2	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510	50.00	13.40	6
20	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,062	2026-02-09	2026-02-17	8	A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200	25.00	34.99	8
21	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,063	2026-06-16			A. Reyes	Direct	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	6.00	14.25	
22	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,064	2026-08-25	2026-08-28	3	M. Okafor	Direct	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200	5.00	34.99	1
23	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,069	2026-07-27	2026-07-30	3	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Cordless Drill 20V Kit	PT-2001	24.00	#####	3,0
24	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,073	2026-04-16	2026-04-20	4	A. Reyes	Direct	Fasteners	Hex Bolt 1/2 x 2, Zinc (100)	FAS-1020	15.00	18.40	2
25	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,078	2026-05-18			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	15.00	14.25	2
26	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,085	2026-07-17			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	20.00	42.00	8
27	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,088	2026-03-18			A. Reyes	Direct	Power Tools	Circular Saw 7-1/4 in	PT-7250	50.00	99.00	4,9

Figure 5 — After Format Columns: consistent ISO dates, number formats, wrapped headings, and tightened column widths.

The width rule is deliberately simple — it measures the *first* data row, not the whole column, so it is fast on large tables. Occasionally a later row is wider than the first and shows as ##### (visible in the Unit Price column above). Those are fixed with a double-click on the column border. This is the "mostly perfect" philosophy: a few seconds of manual tuning on a table that would otherwise have taken twenty minutes to format by hand.

3. Group Columns

Reports are frequently sorted by a hierarchy — Region, then State, then City, then Account — and the columns on the left repeat the same value for row after row. That repetition makes it hard to see where one group ends and the next begins.

Click **Add Group column**, enter the grouping columns from outermost to innermost (by name, number, or letter), and click OK:

A2

fx

Midwest

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	
								Days				
					Order			to				
1	Region	State	City	Account	ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product
2	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,000	2026-07-29	2026-08-04	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Le
3	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,004	2026-06-01			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glas
4	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,008	2026-01-07	2026-01-08	1	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Out
5	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,011	2026-02-24			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screv
6	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,013	2026-08-23	2026-08-28	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screv
7	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,019	2026-01-23	2026-01-27	4	M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw
8	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,023	2026-04-28	2026-05-07	9	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop L
9	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,026	2026-05-11	2026-05-20	9	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinc
10	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,027	2026-08-01			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable
11	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,032	2026-01-02	2026-01-08	6	M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable
12	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,033	2026-06-29			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Le
13	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,035	2026-08-20	2026-08-25	5	A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw
14	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,038	2026-01-15			M. Okafor	Online	Power Tools	Angle Grinc
15	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,041	2026-08-03	2026-08-05	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	Romex 12/
16	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,047	2026-04-06	2026-04-08	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	LED Shop L
17	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,050	2026-06-05	2026-06-10	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop L
18	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,054	2026-04-19	2026-0					LED Shop L
19	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,057	2026-06-25	2026-0					Duplex Out
20	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,062	2026-02-09	2026-0					Framing He
21	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,063	2026-06-16						Torpedo Le
22	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,064	2026-08-25	2026-0					Framing He
23	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,069	2026-07-27	2026-0					Cordless D
24	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,073	2026-04-16	2026-0					Hex Bolt 1,
25	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,078	2026-05-18						Torpedo Le
26	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,085	2026-07-17			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop L
27	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,088	2026-03-18			A. Reyes	Direct	Power Tools	Circular Sa
28	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,089	2026-03-18			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop L

Dynamic Groups

?

×

Group columns, outermost level first.

Enter column names, numbers, or letters, separated by commas:

1,2,3,4

OK

Cancel

Figure 6 — The Dynamic Groups prompt. Columns 1–4 are Region, State, City, and Account.

LDS+N adds conditional formatting to the table that does two things:

- **Dims repeated values.** Within each group, only the first occurrence of a value is shown in normal text; the repeats are shown in light grey. The values are still there, still filterable, still sortable — they are just quieter.
- **Draws a border between groups** at each level, so the boundaries of a state, a city, or an account are visible at a glance.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	
								Days to Ship								
1	Region	State	City	Account	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product	SKU	Qty	Price	Ex
2	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,000	2026-07-29	2026-08-04	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	50.00	14.25	
3	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Ridge Distributors	41,004	2026-06-01			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glasses, Clear (12)	SF-0012	50.00	27.60	1
4	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,008	2026-01-07	2026-01-08	1	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510	10.00	13.40	
5	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,011	2026-02-24			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	50.00	31.90	1
6	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Granite Fabrication	41,013	2026-08-23	2026-08-28	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	10.00	31.90	
7	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,019	2026-01-23	2026-01-27	4	M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	6.00	22.75	
8	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,023	2026-04-28	2026-05-07	9	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	15.00	42.00	
9	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,026	2026-05-11	2026-05-20	9	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500	8.00	64.50	
10	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,027	2026-08-01			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	2.00	19.50	
11	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,032	2026-01-02	2026-01-08	6	M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	10.00	19.50	
12	Midwest	Kentucky	Louisville	Anchor Outfitters	41,033	2026-06-29			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	4.00	14.25	
13	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,035	2026-08-20	2026-08-25	5	A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	20.00	22.75	
14	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,038	2026-01-15			M. Okafor	Online	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500	40.00	64.50	2
15	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,041	2026-08-03	2026-08-05	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	Romex 12/2 NM-B 250 ft	EL-1225	5.00	118.00	
16	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,047	2026-04-06	2026-04-08	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	24.00	42.00	1
17	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,050	2026-06-05	2026-06-10	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	30.00	42.00	1
18	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Industrial	41,054	2026-04-19	2026-04-28	9	A. Reyes	Distributor	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	8.00	42.00	
19	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,057	2026-06-25	2026-06-27	2	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510	50.00	13.40	
20	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,062	2026-02-09	2026-02-17	8	A. Reyes	Online	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200	25.00	34.99	
21	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,063	2026-06-16			A. Reyes	Direct	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	6.00	14.25	
22	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Oak Outfitters	41,064	2026-08-25	2026-08-28	3	M. Okafor	Direct	Hand Tools	Framing Hammer 22 oz	HT-2200	5.00	34.99	
23	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,069	2026-07-27	2026-07-30	3	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Cordless Drill 20V Kit	PT-2001	24.00	129.00	3
24	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,073	2026-04-16	2026-04-20	4	A. Reyes	Direct	Fasteners	Hex Bolt 1/2 x 2, Zinc (100)	FAS-1020	15.00	18.40	
25	Midwest	Kentucky	Lexington	Beacon Distributors	41,078	2026-05-18			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	15.00	14.25	
26	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,085	2026-07-17			A. Reyes	Online	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	20.00	42.00	
27	Midwest	Ohio	Cincinnati	Ridge Fabrication	41,088	2026-03-18			A. Reyes	Direct	Power Tools	Circular Saw 7-1/4 in	PT-7250	50.00	99.00	4

Figure 7 — After Group Columns: repeats dimmed and borders drawn at each level of the hierarchy.

The formatting is **dynamic**: it is driven by a small worksheet function (installed by the **Install Dynamic Groups function** button) and by conditional formatting rules, so if the table is re-sorted or rows are added, the dimming and borders adjust themselves. Because it is ordinary conditional formatting, it also keeps working in a workbook opened without the add-in, and it can be edited like any other rule — for example, to extend the dimming to a column that depends on one of the group columns.

4. Row Viewer

When a table has twenty-five columns, most of them are off the screen at any given moment. To see the whole record for one row you end up scrolling sideways, losing your place, and scrolling back. The Row Viewer solves this by showing all the fields of the current row in a separate window that follows your selection.

Click **Row Viewer** on the ribbon to open it. It floats beside Excel and stays open while you work; as you move from row to row in the table, the viewer updates. Selecting a field in the viewer selects that cell on the sheet, and the sheet scrolls to bring it into view — so the two windows are always in step.

The Row Viewer window displays the following data for row 1:

Sort	Ordinal	Field	Value	Descen
1	Region	Midwest		
2	State	Kentucky		
3	City	Louisville		
4	Account	Ridge Distributors		
5	Order ID	41,000		
6	Order Date	2026-07-29		
7	Ship Date	2026-08-04		
8	Days to Ship	6		
9	Sales Rep	M. Okafor		
10	Channel	Online		
11	Category	Hand Tools		
12	Product	Torpedo Level 9 in		
13	SKU	HT-0900		
14	Qty	50.00		
15	Unit Price	14.25		
16	Extended	712.50		
17	Discount %	0%		
18	Discount Amt	0.00		
19	Net	712.50		
20	Sales Tax	42.75		
21	Total	755.25		
22	Shipping	6.12		
23	Landed Total	761.37		

The Excel window shows the following table data:

	Account	ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Categ
1	Ridge Distributors	41,000	2026-07-29	2026-08-04	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand
2	Ridge Distributors	41,004	2026-06-01			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety
3	Granite Fabrication	41,008	2026-01-07	2026-01-08	1	A. Reyes	Direct	Electri
4	Granite Fabrication	41,011	2026-02-24			M. Okafor	Online	Faster
5	Granite Fabrication	41,013	2026-08-23	2026-08-28	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Faster
6	Anchor Outfitters	41,019	2026-01-23	2026-01-27	4	M. Okafor	Online	Faster
7	Anchor Outfitters	41,023	2026-04-28	2026-05-07	9	A. Reyes	Direct	Electri
8	Anchor Outfitters	41,026	2026-05-11	2026-05-20	9	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power
9	Anchor Outfitters	41,027	2026-08-01			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand
10	Anchor Outfitters	41,032	2026-01-02	2026-01-08	6	M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand
11	Anchor Outfitters	41,033	2026-06-29			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand
12	Beacon Industrial	41,035	2026-08-20	2026-08-25	5	A. Reyes	Distributor	Faster
13	Beacon Industrial	41,038	2026-01-15			M. Okafor	Online	Power
14	Beacon Industrial	41,041	2026-08-03	2026-08-05	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electri
15	Beacon Industrial	41,047	2026-04-06	2026-04-08	2	M. Okafor	Online	Electri
16	Beacon Industrial	41,050	2026-06-05	2026-06-10	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Electri

Figure 8 — The Row Viewer showing all 25 fields of row 1. Selecting "Discount Amt" in the viewer selected cell R2 on the sheet.

Three things worth knowing:

- **Sort.** The field list can be shown in table order (Ordinal), alphabetically by field name, or by value — useful for spotting which fields are empty or which hold the largest numbers.
- **Search.** Start typing and the list narrows to the fields whose name or value contains what you typed. In Figure 9, typing "disc" leaves just the two discount fields.
- **Keyboard.** The viewer is designed to be driven from the keyboard, so you can page through rows and fields without reaching for the mouse.

Row Viewer - tblMyTable1, row 1 of 179

Sort: ☒ Ordinal ☐ Field ☐ Value ☐ Descen

disc

17	Discount %	0%
18	Discount Amt	0.00

AutoSave Off

File Home Insert Draw Page Layout Formulas Data Review View Automate Develop

Search Worksheets and Tables Row Viewer Formula Report Make Table Format Columns Install Dynamic Groups function Add Group column Back Forward Selection History

R2 =ROUND(P2*Q2,2)

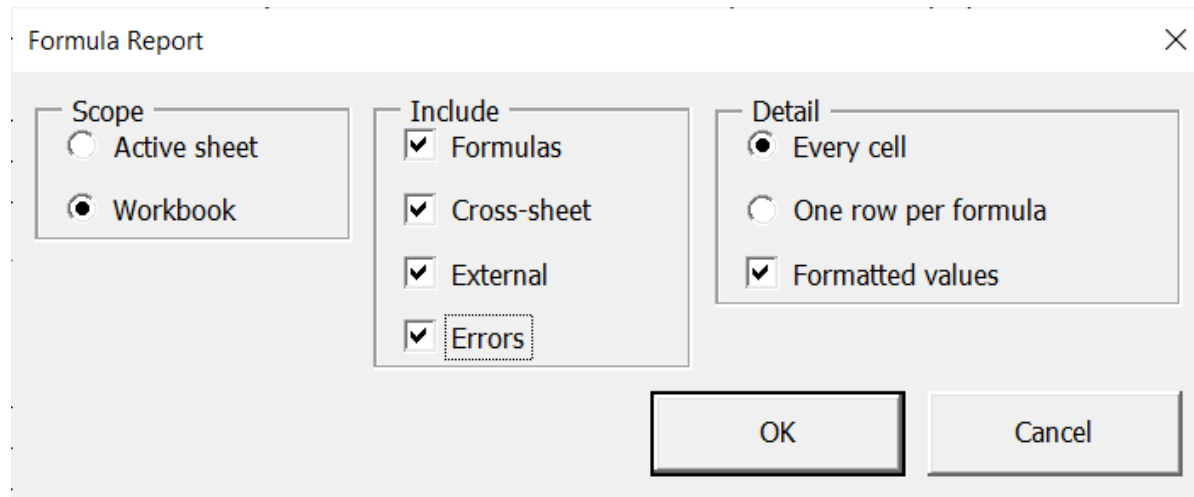
	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y
	Discount Amt	Net	Sales Tax	Total	Shipping	Landed Total	Status	Notes
1	0.00	717.50	42.75	755.25	6.12	761.37	Shipped	

Figure 9 — Row Viewer search: "disc" filters the 25 fields down to the two that match.

5. Formula Report

The last feature is for understanding a workbook rather than tidying it — particularly a workbook someone else built. It answers the question "what formulas are in here, and where?"

Click **Formula Report** and choose what to include:



The screenshot shows the 'Formula Report' dialog box with the following settings:

- Scope:** ☐ Active sheet, ☒ Workbook
- Include:** ☒ Formulas, ☒ Cross-sheet, ☒ External, ☒ Errors
- Detail:** ☒ Every cell, ☐ One row per formula, ☒ Formatted values

Buttons: OK, Cancel

Figure 10 — The Formula Report options. Scope, what to include, and whether to list every cell or one row per distinct formula.

- **Scope** — just the active sheet, or every sheet in the workbook.
- **Include** — ordinary formulas, formulas that reference other sheets, formulas that reference other workbooks, and cells currently showing an error.
- **Detail** — one row for every formula cell, or one row per distinct formula pattern (much shorter for a large table where the same formula is filled down a column).

The result is a new sheet with a table listing each formula. Two columns deserve a mention: **Formula (R1C1)** shows the formula in relative notation, which is identical for every cell in a filled-down column, and **Count** shows how many cells share that pattern. Repeats of the same pattern are dimmed using the same Dynamic Groups treatment described above, so each distinct formula stands out with its count beside it. **Formula (A1)** shows the familiar cell-address version, and **Value** shows what the cell currently evaluates to.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Select a report row, then press Alt+Right (or ribbon Forward) to go to that cell. Alt+Left returns here.					
2						
3	Sheet	Formula (R1C1)	Count	Cell	Formula (A1)	Value
154	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R152	=ROUND(P152*Q152,2)	16.46
155	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R153	=ROUND(P153*Q153,2)	0.00
156	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R154	=ROUND(P154*Q154,2)	11.04
157	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R155	=ROUND(P155*Q155,2)	0.71
158	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R156	=ROUND(P156*Q156,2)	73.60
159	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R157	=ROUND(P157*Q157,2)	14.36
160	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R158	=ROUND(P158*Q158,2)	0.00
161	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R159	=ROUND(P159*Q159,2)	2.76
162	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R160	=ROUND(P160*Q160,2)	0.00
163	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R161	=ROUND(P161*Q161,2)	0.00
164	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R162	=ROUND(P162*Q162,2)	138.00
165	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R163	=ROUND(P163*Q163,2)	3.56
166	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R164	=ROUND(P164*Q164,2)	3.50
167	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R165	=ROUND(P165*Q165,2)	0.00
168	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R166	=ROUND(P166*Q166,2)	10.50
169	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R167	=ROUND(P167*Q167,2)	0.00
170	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R168	=ROUND(P168*Q168,2)	0.00
171	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R169	=ROUND(P169*Q169,2)	13.17
172	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R170	=ROUND(P170*Q170,2)	42.00
173	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R171	=ROUND(P171*Q171,2)	78.73
174	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R172	=ROUND(P172*Q172,2)	6.30
175	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R173	=ROUND(P173*Q173,2)	79.75
176	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R174	=ROUND(P174*Q174,2)	0.00
177	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R175	=ROUND(P175*Q175,2)	0.00
178	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R176	=ROUND(P176*Q176,2)	3.56
179	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R177	=ROUND(P177*Q177,2)	0.00
180	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R178	=ROUND(P178*Q178,2)	4.20
181	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R179	=ROUND(P179*Q179,2)	0.00
182	Orders	=ROUND(RC[-2]*RC[-1],2)	179	R180	=ROUND(P180*Q180,2)	0.00
183	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S2	=P2-R2	712.50
184	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S3	=P3-R3	1,242.00
185	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S4	=P4-R4	113.90
186	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S5	=P5-R5	1,595.00
187	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S6	=P6-R6	319.00
188	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S7	=P7-R7	129.67
189	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S8	=P8-R8	630.00
190	Orders	=RC[-3]-RC[-1]	179	S9	=P9-R9	438.60

Figure 11 — The Formula Report sheet. The instruction in row 1 explains the navigation; the highlighted row (S5) is about to be jumped to.

The line at the top of the report (see previous page) is the important part: **select a report row and press Alt+Right** (or ribbon Forward) to jump to that cell in the source sheet. **Alt+Left** brings you back to the report. This is the Back/Forward feature from the start of this document, and it turns the report from a static listing into a way of walking through a workbook formula by formula.

	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V
	Order Date	Ship Date	Days to Ship	Sales Rep	Channel	Category	Product	SKU	Qty	Unit Price	Extended	Discount %	Discount Amt	Net	Sales Tax	Total	Shipped
2	2026-07-29	2026-08-04	6	M. Okafor	Online	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	50.00	14.25	712.50	0%	0.00	712.50	42.75	755.25	6.
3	2026-06-01			M. Okafor	Distributor	Safety	Safety Glasses, Clear (12)	SF-0012	50.00	27.60	1,380.00	10%	138.00	1,242.00	74.52	1,316.52	27.
4	2026-01-07	2026-01-08	1	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	Duplex Outlet 15A (10)	EL-1510	10.00	13.40	134.00	15%	20.10	113.90	6.83	120.73	25.
5	2026-02-24			M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	50.00	31.90	1,595.00	0%	0.00	1,595.00	95.70	1,690.70	0.
6	2026-08-23	2026-08-28	5	M. Okafor	Distributor	Fasteners	Deck Screw #10 x 3 (5 lb)	FAS-1003	10.00	31.90	319.00	0%	0.00	319.00	19.14	338.14	38.
7	2026-01-23	2026-01-27	4	M. Okafor	Online	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	6.00	22.75	136.50	5%	6.83	129.67	7.78	137.45	1.
8	2026-04-28	2026-05-07	9	A. Reyes	Direct	Electrical	LED Shop Light 4 ft	EL-0400	15.00	42.00	630.00	0%	0.00	630.00	37.80	667.80	31.
9	2026-05-11	2026-05-20	9	M. Okafor	Distributor	Power Tools	Angle Grinder 4-1/2 in	PT-4500	8.00	64.50	516.00	15%	77.40	438.60	26.32	464.92	39.
10	2026-08-01			A. Reyes	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	2.00	19.50	39.00	10%	3.90	35.10	2.11	37.21	9.
11	2026-01-02	2026-01-08	6	M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Adjustable Wrench 10 in	HT-1000	10.00	19.50	195.00	0%	0.00	195.00	11.70	206.70	5.
12	2026-06-29			M. Okafor	Distributor	Hand Tools	Torpedo Level 9 in	HT-0900	4.00	14.25	57.00	0%	0.00	57.00	3.42	60.42	0.
13	2026-08-20	2026-08-25	5	A. Reyes	Distributor	Fasteners	Lag Screw 3/8 x 4 (50)	FAS-3804	20.00	22.75	455.00	15%	68.25	386.75	23.21	409.96	22.

Figure 12 — After Alt+Right from the report row for S5: Excel has jumped to the Orders sheet with S5 selected and its formula in the formula bar.

Putting it together

On a new export, the whole sequence takes well under a minute:

- Open the file and click somewhere in the data.
- **Make Table** — filters, frozen header, gridlines off.
- **Format Columns** — glance at the data types, Close, fix any overflowed (#####) columns.
- **Add Group column** if the data is sorted by a hierarchy.
- Open the **Row Viewer** if you need to read whole rows; run a **Formula Report** if you need to understand what the sheet is calculating.
- Use **Alt+Left** and **Alt+Right** throughout to move between where you are and where you were.

Because the choices you make in Format Columns are remembered by column name, the second time the same report arrives the process is faster still.